

A

In these television interviews, Members of Parliament (MPs) are defending their positions.

Interviewer Recently you seem to have **come out against**¹ those in your party who want stronger anti-terrorist laws. Why?

MP I haven't changed my position at all, and I **stick by** what I've always said. Those who **side with**² the terrorists or support them in any way must be opposed. But we need a mature debate about the causes of terrorism.

¹ stated publicly that you opposed an issue (opposite: **come out in favour of**)

² support a person or group in an argument

Interviewer You said you were determined to introduce higher fuel charges, but after the opposition from the trucking companies you seem to have **caved in**³. Why?

MP We are a listening party and we always **defer to**⁴ expert opinion. We were advised that higher charges would have a negative economic effect in the long term, so we have decided to **go with**⁵ that advice.

³ agreed to something that you were against before, because of persuasion or threats

⁴ (formal) accept someone else's opinion because they know more or are more important

⁵ accept a plan or an idea

Interviewer You seem to be **leaning** increasingly **towards**⁶ more conservative policies. Is there any truth in the rumour that you are about to **cross over**⁷ to the Conservative Party?

MP No. The values I **stand for**⁸ are liberal values, but I see no point in **siding against**⁹ the Conservative Party on those issues where I agree with them.

⁶ support or begin to support a particular set of ideas or a particular political party

⁷ start to support a different, often opposing, person or group

⁸ support

⁹ opposing a person or group in an argument

B

Note the phrasal verbs for supporting and opposing people or views in these newspaper extracts.

17-year-old boy claims he was **egged on**¹ by his friends to steal cars.

¹ encouraged to do something, often something that is wrong, stupid or dangerous

Cheered on² by her supporters, Sadie Hinds beat the world record.

² received encouraging shouts

Mrs Gilmore, who celebrated her 104th birthday, when asked what her secret was, said she **swears by**³ a glass of hot milk with a little sugar every night before bed.

³ believes that something is very effective and that it will always work well

Mr West said the club would **not hear of**⁴ letting children attend the event.

⁴ not allow something, or not allow someone to do something (always in the negative)

The peace campaign was **buoyed up**⁵ recently by a donation of €1,000,000.

⁵ supported and made more successful

He was someone who always **stuck up for**⁶ the rights of the poor and the homeless.

⁶ (informal) defended or fought for something important